PimpriChinchwad Education Trust's **PimpriChinchwad College of Engineering (PCCoE)** (An Autonomous Institute)
Affiliated to SavitribaiPhule Pune University(SPPU)

MDM-Digital Marketing - Capstone Project [BCE27MD06]

Department: Computer Engg. (RL) **Academic Year: 2026-2027** **Semester: I**

Year: B. Tech **Group ID: 21** **Date: 11/09/2026**

Problem Statement: Digital Transformation and Marketing Platform for Vishal Enterprises

SDG Goals aligned with the project:

SDG No.	Name
SDG 8	Decent Work and Economic Growth
SDG 9	Industry, Innovation and Infrastructure

Team Members:

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Project Guide: Mr. Ganesh Deshmukh

1) Introduction

Background of the Selected Business/Domain

Vishal Enterprises is a local offline retail business dealing in cement, Phelopilex/PVC pipes, basins and hardware-related products. The business mainly depends on physical store visits, local customer awareness, references and word-of-mouth communication. Although the business serves customers through its existing offline operations, limited digital visibility can make it difficult for new customers to discover the shop, understand its product categories and contact the business before visiting.

Role of Digital Marketing

Digital marketing can help Vishal Enterprises extend its existing offline presence to online platforms where customers increasingly search for local businesses and product information. A Google Business Profile can improve local discovery and provide essential information such as location and contact details, while Instagram and Facebook can be used to display products, offers and informative content. WhatsApp Business can provide a direct communication channel for product enquiries. A simple website or digital catalogue can further organize product information and help customers understand the available categories before visiting the shop.

Motivation

The main motivation of the project is to bridge the gap between the existing offline business and the digital customer journey. Instead of replacing the current store-based business model with a complex e-commerce system, the project focuses on creating a practical and affordable digital marketing ecosystem. This is suitable for a local SME because digital transformation should consider the organization's available resources, business requirements and limitations. The proposed approach therefore focuses on improving discoverability, product information, customer communication and measurable digital engagement.

2) Literature / Market Review

Research Paper 1 – SME Digital Transformation

Sagala and Őri (2024) presented a systematic literature review on digital transformation in small and medium-sized enterprises. The study examined factors affecting successful SME digital transformation and emphasized the importance of aligning digital initiatives with the organization's existing capabilities and limitations. The study supports an incremental and business-oriented approach to digital transformation. For Vishal Enterprises, this justifies implementing essential digital channels such as Google Business, social media, WhatsApp Business and a simple website instead of introducing an unnecessarily complex digital system.

Research Paper 2 – Social Media Marketing in Indian SMEs

Chatterjee and Kar (2020) empirically investigated social-media marketing among SMEs in India. Their study examined why SMEs adopt social media and its impact on business outcomes and customer connections. The findings demonstrate the relevance of social media as a marketing channel for SMEs. This supports the inclusion of Instagram and Facebook in the proposed project because these platforms can help Vishal Enterprises display products, communicate with customers and increase its digital reach.

Research Paper 3 – Digital Marketing Strategy and SME Performance

Wu, Botella-Carrubi and Blanco-González-Tejero (2024) studied the relationship between digital marketing strategy and SME performance. The research highlights the importance of developing digital marketing capabilities systematically rather than treating individual digital activities as isolated tasks. This supports the proposed project because Vishal Enterprises requires a coordinated strategy involving local search, social media, content and customer communication rather than simply creating separate social-media accounts.

Research Paper 4 – Digital Transformation and SME Resilience

Hokmabadi, Rezvani and de Matos (2024) conducted a systematic review of digital transformation and business resilience in SMEs. The study discusses digital capabilities such as digital marketing, social media and SEO as important elements of SME digital development. This provides justification for including local SEO, social-media marketing and digital analytics in the proposed solution.

Existing Market Solutions

Existing platforms such as Google Business Profile, Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp Business and website/catalogue platforms already provide individual digital marketing capabilities. Google supports local business discovery, social-media platforms support content and engagement, WhatsApp supports direct communication, and websites provide structured business and product information.

However, these platforms are generally used independently. For a small offline retailer, simply creating multiple accounts does not automatically create a complete marketing strategy. The proposed project therefore focuses on integrating these platforms around the actual customer journey of Vishal Enterprises.

3) Gap Identification

Existing Solutions Provide

Existing digital platforms provide several useful capabilities:

- Google Business Profile provides local business visibility and location information.
- Instagram and Facebook provide product promotion and customer engagement.
- WhatsApp Business provides direct customer communication and enquiries.
- Websites/catalogues provide structured product and business information.
- Analytics platforms provide information about digital performance.

Limitations of Existing Practices

The major limitation is that these platforms are often used separately without a business-specific strategy. A local offline retailer may have individual digital accounts but still lack a coordinated process connecting **online discovery, product exploration, customer enquiry and physical store visits**. Generic digital marketing solutions may also be unnecessarily complex for a small business with limited resources.

Identified Gap

The identified gap is therefore **not the absence of digital platforms**, but the absence of a simple, integrated and business-specific digital marketing workflow designed for a local building-material and hardware retailer.

How the Proposed Project Addresses the Gap

The project addresses this gap by integrating Google Business Profile, Instagram, Facebook, WhatsApp Business and a simple website/product catalogue into one practical digital marketing framework. The proposed customer journey is:

Discover → Explore → Enquire → Visit/Purchase → Review

This approach connects digital marketing activities with the existing offline business rather than attempting to replace the physical store.

4) Problem Statement

Vishal Enterprises is an offline retail business dealing in cement, Phelopilex/PVC pipes, basins and hardware products. The business mainly depends on physical visits, local awareness and word-of-mouth. Due to limited digital presence, potential customers may find it difficult to discover the business online, explore products or contact the shop before visiting.

The project aims to create a practical digital marketing platform using Google Business Profile, social media, WhatsApp Business and a simple product catalogue to improve local visibility, customer enquiries and support offline store visits.

Target Customers: Local homeowners, contractors, plumbers, builders and other customers requiring construction and

hardware products.

5) Objectives

1. To establish and optimize Google Business Profile, Instagram, Facebook and WhatsApp Business for Vishal Enterprises.
2. To develop a simple website/product catalogue for displaying major product categories and business information.
3. To provide a direct WhatsApp/call-based enquiry facility for product availability, pricing and customer requirements.
4. To implement local SEO, keyword research, social-media content and customer reviews to improve digital visibility.
5. To measure reach, engagement, website visits, enquiries and reviews to evaluate and improve marketing performance.

6) Scope of the Project

- **Market & Competitor Analysis:** Study nearby competitors and their digital presence to identify opportunities for improvement.
- **Customer Analysis:** Identify key customer groups and their information and communication needs.
- **Website & Product Catalogue:** Develop a simple digital platform to display business information and major product categories.
- **Local SEO & Keywords:** Identify relevant local keywords and optimize digital profiles for better local discovery.
- **Social Media Marketing:** Use Instagram and Facebook for product promotion, informative content and customer engagement.
- **WhatsApp Business:** Provide a direct channel for product enquiries and customer communication.
- **Analytics:** Track reach, engagement, website visits, enquiries and reviews to evaluate marketing performance.
- **AI Assistance:** Use AI where suitable for content ideas, captions and basic marketing support.

7) Tools and Technologies

- **Google Business Profile & Google Maps:** For local business visibility, location and customer discovery.
- **Instagram & Facebook:** For product promotion, informative content and customer engagement.
- **WhatsApp Business:** For direct customer enquiries and communication.
- **HTML, CSS & JavaScript / Website Platform:** For developing a simple website and product catalogue.
- **Canva:** For creating product posts, promotional graphics and visual content.
- **Google Analytics & Search Console:** For monitoring website traffic, search performance and user interactions.
- **Google Trends / Keyword Planner:** For identifying relevant and locally useful keywords.
- **Generative AI:** For assisting with content ideas, captions and marketing concepts.

8) Proposed Methodology

The project will follow a step-by-step digital transformation approach:

1. Business Study → 2. Customer & Competitor Analysis → 3. Digital Strategy → 4. Platform Setup → 5. Content Creation → 6. Launch & Promotion → 7. Analytics & Improvement

First, the business requirements, products and target customers will be studied. Competitor and keyword analysis will then be conducted to identify suitable digital marketing opportunities. Based on these findings, Google Business, social-media

profiles, WhatsApp Business and the website/catalogue will be prepared. Relevant content will be created and published, followed by performance tracking through analytics and customer feedback.

This approach allows the digital presence to be developed according to the actual business requirements and available resources

9) Result and Discussion

The expected result is a coordinated digital presence for Vishal Enterprises connecting Google search, social media, website/product catalogue and WhatsApp Business.

The effectiveness of the project will be discussed using measurable indicators such as online reach, engagement, website visits, customer enquiries and reviews. These results will help identify which digital activities are useful for reaching local customers and where improvements are required.

The overall expected outcome is to strengthen the customer journey from online discovery to product enquiry and offline store visit/purchase.

10) Conclusion

The proposed project aims to strengthen Vishal Enterprises' existing offline business through a practical digital marketing ecosystem. By integrating Google Business Profile, social media, WhatsApp Business and a simple product catalogue, the project will improve local visibility, product discovery and customer communication.

The approach is feasible for a local business because it focuses on essential digital channels rather than a complex e-commerce system. Performance measurement through reach, engagement, visits, enquiries and reviews will also provide a basis for continuous improvement.

Overall, the project connects the existing offline strength of Vishal Enterprises with a stronger digital customer journey.

11) References

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Guide Approval

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